The Bird and the Turn

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 5

A bird sat quietly above the first mooring post. Nib held the rope and considered whether the bird might prefer another branch. Lark found a second low post within the boat's safe reach. The bird's perch could remain exactly where it was.

“The bird has chosen an inconvenient branch,” Nib complained softly. “We can choose another post,” Lark replied kindly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **her**

“Ir in bird and ur in turn can spell the vowel we already met in fern,” Lark modeled clearly. “Read bird, turn, and fur. Similar sounds can have different spellings, so we look at the actual letters instead of swapping them in our minds.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try bird, turn, fur. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read turn on the mooring note,” Lark invited gently. “Which post lets the rope turn without entering the perch space?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **A bird can turn. Its wing is by a fern.**

“What is beside the fern?” Lark asked gently. “Which sentence lets you check?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib brought the rope around the lower post while keeping its boat end attached. Lark checked the line from deck to shore. The boat settled securely at the bend, the cart route stayed clear, and the bird kept its comfortable branch. Ahead, two paths led toward Reed Creek's reading bank.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write turn beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark drew the second post on your route page. Nobody needed to move the bird to make the boat safe. Now the crew could inspect the narrow path and the broad cart route from solid ground.